

Every Client, Every Business Model

Employment models, accessible pricing, and why no single path fits every practitioner

Learning Objectives

- Compare the major business and employment models available to a beauty practitioner
- Design accessible pricing without devaluing the craft it prices
- Apply sliding-scale and community pricing responsibly
- Explain why no single business model fits every practitioner or every market

No single path

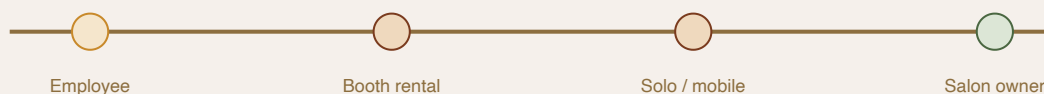
Just as Course VI taught you that no single bridal template fits every bride, no single business model fits every practitioner. The right structure depends on capital available, risk tolerance, family circumstances, and personal preference — and choosing deliberately, rather than defaulting into whatever model a first employer happened to use, is itself a business skill.

Five models, compared honestly

- **Salon employee.** Lowest financial risk, steady base income, least control over pricing, schedule, and clientele.
- **Booth or chair rental.** Greater independence and higher earning ceiling, but fixed rent due regardless of how many clients book that month.
- **Solo studio.** Full control and full responsibility — every business function from Module One lands on one person.
- **Mobile or freelance.** Lowest overhead and highest flexibility, but travel time and equipment logistics eat into billable hours.

- **Salon owner.** Highest potential ceiling and highest responsibility, including managing other practitioners' livelihoods, not just your own.

◆ Figure 2.1 · Risk and Independence, Compared



Independence and risk generally rise together — choose deliberately, not by default.

Accessible pricing without devaluing the craft

Serving clients across a genuine economic range is possible without a race-to-the-bottom discount culture: offer off-peak or weekday pricing tiers rather than permanently discounting your full-price service, run occasional community or student days with clearly bounded scope, and never frame a discount as the "real" price with everyone else paying a markup. Every discount is real, quantifiable revenue leaving the business — offer it deliberately, not apologetically or by default.

Key Terms

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Practical Activity · Choose and Justify

For a hypothetical practitioner profile you design yourself, choose the business model that best fits their capital, risk tolerance, and life circumstances, and justify your choice against the other four options.